HOME ABOUT MEMBERSHIP NEWS & EVENTS COUNTRY CONTACT



WEBSITE AUDIT & POSITIONING STRATEGY REPORT

Sri Lanka – France Business Council (SLFBC)

Audit target: https://www.slfbc.lk/index.php

Prepared: 24 September 2026

Scope: content architecture, positioning, UI/UX, functionality, trust, mobile readiness, SEO fundamentals and modernization opportunities.

This audit evaluates the requested www.slfbc.lk site.

Executive Summary

Key Finding: The current SLFBC website communicates the council's basic purpose, membership and contact information, but its presentation and information architecture feel closer to a legacy institutional website than a modern bilateral business council platform. The strongest opportunity is not simply a visual redesign: the site should make the Council's value to Sri Lanka–France business relationships immediately clear, while making membership, events, partnerships, trade/investment opportunities and council leadership easy to discover.

The requested site currently contains a useful navigation structure—About, Membership, News & Events, Country and Contact—but several pages rely on older PHP URLs, legacy external links, inconsistent contact details and content that appears dated. The homepage also has limited conversion-oriented messaging beyond informational content.

Primary Priorities

- **Modernize the homepage** around the Council's bilateral business value: connect, facilitate, promote and represent.
- **Create clear pathways** for Members, Prospective Members, French Businesses, Sri Lankan Businesses and Institutional Partners.
- **Bring leadership and committee information up to date** and present it with consistent professional portraits and role information.
- **Consolidate news/event content into the SLFBC domain** instead of relying on legacy external event destinations.
- **Standardize contact details, social links**, footer information and copyright/version information.
- **Improve mobile responsiveness**, spacing, typography, image treatment and accessibility.
- **Introduce stronger calls to action** such as Join the Council, Explore Members, View Upcoming Events and Contact the Secretariat.
- **Create a more useful France / Sri Lanka country-information section** with business-relevant content rather than generic country information.

Overall Website Direction

Recommended direction: A premium, institutional, bilateral-business platform combining the credibility of the Ceylon Chamber of Commerce with a modern international-business presentation. The site should feel authoritative and current without becoming overly corporate or promotional.

1. Proposed Homepage Content & Structure

Hero Section

Replace the generic introductory treatment with a concise bilateral-business proposition.

Suggested headline: Connecting Sri Lanka & France for Business, Trade and Investment

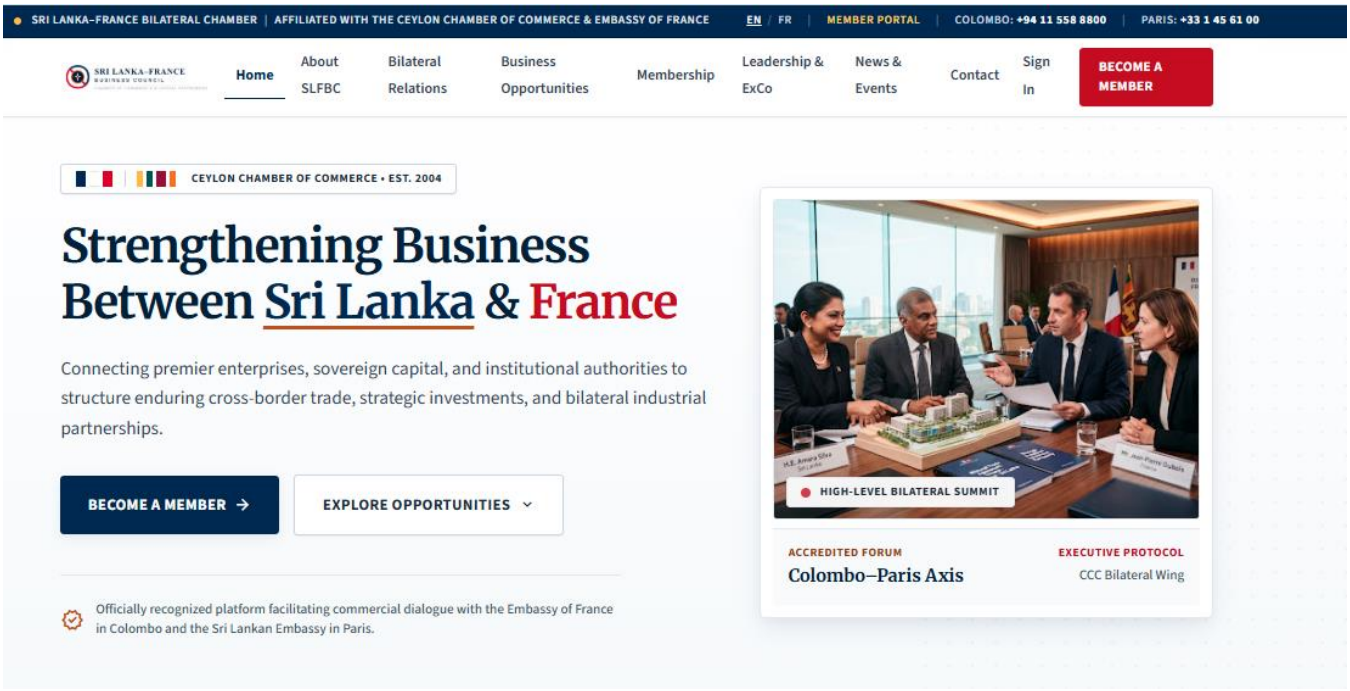
Supporting line: The Sri Lanka–France Business Council connects businesses, institutions and investors to strengthen commercial relationships between the two countries.

Primary CTA: Join the Council

Secondary CTA: Explore Members

Homepage Sections

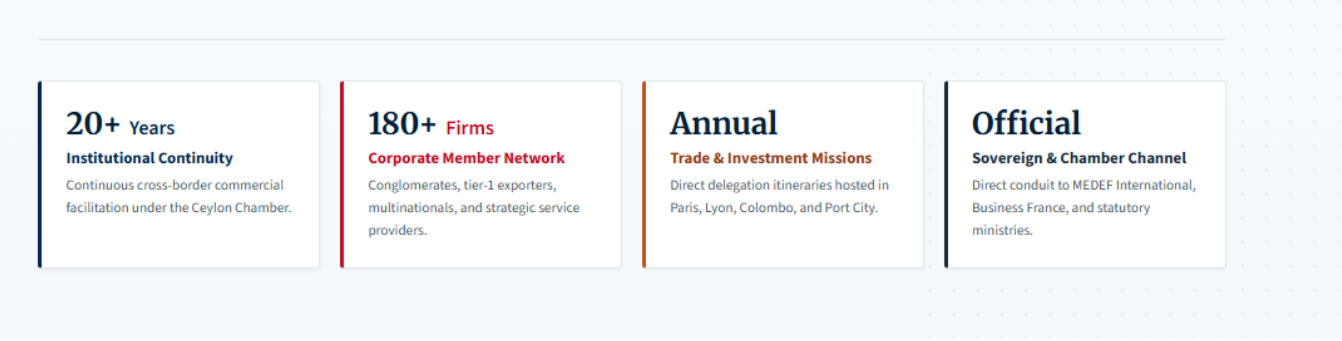
1. **Hero: bilateral business proposition + two clear CTAs.**

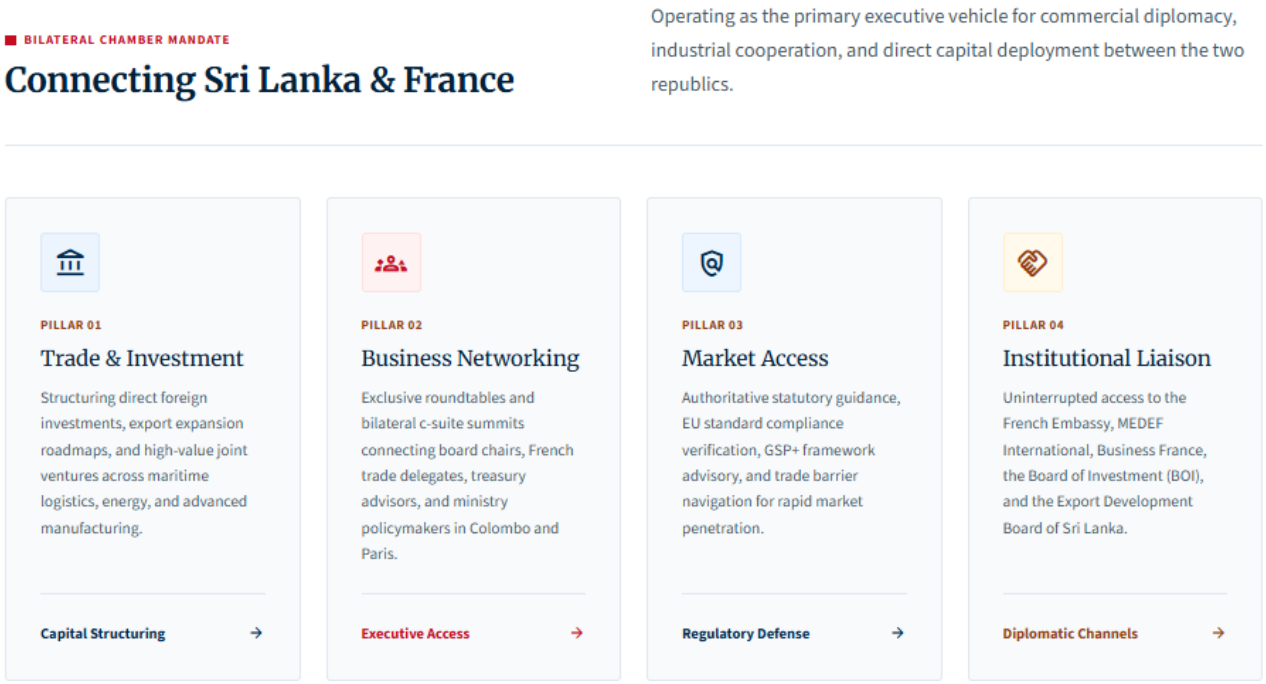


2. **Council at a Glance:** Established 2004 | 70 members (subject to current verification) | Ceylon Chamber of Commerce.
3. **What We Do:** Trade & Business Facilitation; Investment & Partnerships; Networking & Events; Market & Country Information; Institutional Coordination.
4. **Why SLFBC:** Access to business networks, bilateral dialogue, market connections, events and institutional relationships.
5. **Featured Members:** selected member logos with Explore All Members CTA.
6. **Upcoming Events**: 3–4 current events with dates, location and registration CTA.
7. **Latest News:** current news/articles with publication dates.
8. **Leadership**: President and key committee members with professional portraits.
9. **France–Sri Lanka Business Focus:** concise current themes, sectors or opportunities.
10. **Partners & Institutions**: Chamber, Embassy and relevant institutional relationships.
11. **Final CTA:** Join the Council / Contact the Secretariat.

Homepage Content Issue

The current homepage uses a Vision, Mission and Services block, but these statements are abstract. They should be retained as supporting content rather than the main conversion message. The homepage should answer three questions within the first screen: What is SLFBC? Who is it for? What can a visitor do next?





PRIORITY COMMERCIAL TRACKS

Explore Business Opportunities

Targeted sectors and bilateral initiatives primed for cross-border expansion, joint ventures, and capital investments.

VIEW ALL DOSSIERS →

CAPITAL PROJECTS

Investment & Renewable Infrastructure

Direct French EPC involvement in offshore wind farms in Mannar Basin, micro-grids, commercial green hydrogen generation, and port crane electrifications.

ACTIVE PROJECT PIPELINE — Inquire →

TRADE & EXPORT

High-Value Bilateral Trade & Exports

Expansion of GI-certified Ceylon Cinnamon, ethical apparel supply lines, aircraft tire rubber components, and high-purity graphite into French aerospace tiers.

BILATERAL MATCHMAKING — Inquire →

ADVISORY

Market Entry & Regulatory Navigation

Step-by-step establishment advisory, corporate taxation optimization, BOI Section 17 incentive structuring, and local partner vetting.

STATUTORY ROADMAPS — Inquire →

PARTNERSHIPS

Maritime & Supply Chain Alliances

Strengthening joint shipping consortia, cold chain logistics for perishables, port equipment supply, and French multimodal network integration.

SUPPLY LOGISTICS — Inquire →

HOSPITALITY

Luxury Tourism & Culinary Exchange

Co-investments in regenerative luxury eco-resorts, French hospitality brand expansions in Colombo, and bilateral Sommelier and gastronomy training institutes.

BOUTIQUE ASSETS — Inquire →

DEEPTECH

Software Engineering & AI Venture Alliances

Pairing top-quartile Sri Lankan enterprise software engineers with French Station F startups, European fintech operators, and Agritech R&D centers.

ENGINEERING CORRIDORS — Inquire →

STRATEGIC BILATERAL CORRIDORS

Two Economies. One High-Value Axis.

Unlocking complementary strengths across the Indo-Pacific maritime epicenter and Europe's premier industrial power.

INWARD CORRIDOR

Why Sri Lanka

FOR FRENCH ENTERPRISES

A strategically positioned transshipment hub at the center of the world's most congested sea lanes, combining competitive operational costs with sophisticated human capital.

Indian Ocean Maritime & Logistics Hub

Colombo Port ranks among the world's top 25 container ports, offering French shipping and supply chain conglomerates unrivaled connectivity to South Asia.

High-Growth Transition Sectors

Vast multi-gigawatt pipelines in offshore wind, solar, green hydrogen, alongside carbon-neutral ethical apparel manufacturing and luxury hospitality development.

Port City Colombo Special Economic Zone

Independent common-law commercial regulatory framework, multi-currency banking, and statutory tax holidays designed explicitly for European multinationals.

BOI & CCC FACILITATION

Explore Entry Inquiries →

OUTWARD CORRIDOR

Why France

FOR SRI LANKAN ENTERPRISES

The beating heart of Continental Europe's single market, offering world class infrastructure, aerospace engineering authority, and unmatched luxury consumer purchasing power.

Aerospace & Deep Industrial Technology

Access to Airbus supply chains, precision defense technologies, clean propulsion engineering, and joint European R&D consortia.

Gateway to 450 Million EU Consumers

France stands as the primary distribution nexus for Ceylon specialty single-origin tea, ethical apparel, rubber industrial products, and specialized IT export services.

Global Benchmark in Luxury & Gastronomy

Direct commercial alignment with leading French luxury houses, Michelin-starred culinary academies, and sustainable hospitality consortiums.

BUSINESS FRANCE LIAISON

Access European Market →

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ENGINEERING CORRIDORS — Inquire →

CORPORATE CHAMBER AFFILIATION

Become Part of the Sri Lanka–France Business Network

Council membership provides institutional stature, direct c-level dialogue with sovereign trade delegations, and immediate operational leverage in both jurisdictions.

High-Level Bilateral Networking

Closed-door sessions with visiting French ministries, European ambassadors, and state delegations.

Priority Delegation Participation

Preferential registration on outbound trade missions to Paris, Marseille, Lyon, and MEDEF summits.

Inward Investment Dossiers

Quarterly intelligence briefings on regulatory adjustments, tax treaties, and commercial opportunities.

C-Level Matchmaking

Direct bespoke introductions to French corporate buyers, joint-venture partners, and distributors.

Institutional Representation

Advocacy on bilateral commercial disputes, bilateral treaties, and trade barriers via the Ceylon Chamber.

Customs & Tariff Advisory

Specialized advisory support on EU trade requirements, rules of origin, and GSP+ technical dossiers.

RECOGNIZED MEMBERSHIP CLASSIFICATIONS

Patron Member	Corporate Member	Associate Member	Overseas Affiliate
Tier 1 Conglomerates	Active Trading Firms	SMEs & Consultancies	France-Based Entities

SECRETARIAT INTAKE

Initiate Council Accreditation

Applications are reviewed and endorsed through the bilateral screening committee convened under the Ceylon Chamber of Commerce.

Company / Organization Legal Entity

e.g. Hayleys PLC / CMA CGM Lanka

Corporate Email

corporate@enterprise.com

Primary Corridor Interest

France Market Access (Outw

SUBMIT MEMBERSHIP DOSSIER →

Prefer physical submission? Download Prospectus (PDF)

BILATERAL DISPATCHES

News & Official Events

ALL UPDATES | SUMMITS | DELEGATIONS

UPCOMING SUMMIT — OCT 22–24, 2026

2026 Sri Lanka–France Bilateral Investment Forum

Hôtel de Crillon, Place de la Concorde, Paris & Hybrid Video Link. Convening chief executives and ministry delegates on sovereign infrastructure financing.

Paris, France & Live Satellite

● REGISTRATION ACTIVE — Program Details →

CHAMBER COMMUNIQUÉ — MAR 14, 2026

French Business Delegation Concludes Indian Ocean Logistics Tour

A high-level mission representing 14 French multinational industrial contractors evaluated deep-water port operations and off-grid green energy opportunities at the Port of Colombo.

Joint Communiqué • Colombo Secretariat

COMMERCIAL REPORT — Read Briefing →

PROTOCOL GALA — FEB 02, 2026

Annual Bilateral Gala Dinner & Sovereign Trade Awards

Hosted at the Official Residence of the Ambassador of France in Colombo, recognizing exemplary exporters in Ceylon tea, apparel innovation, and aerospace supply.

Official Gallery & Laureates

DIPLOMATIC ARCHIVE — View Laureates →

GOVERNANCE & EXECUTIVE LEADERSHIP

Meet the Executive Committee

Led by captains of industry, seasoned diplomats, and corporate directors dedicated to accelerating Franco-Lankan economic partnership.



PRESIDENT'S DISPATCH

Jean-Pierre Dubois

Executive President, Sri Lanka–France Business Council

> *"Our bilateral trade corridor is entering an era defined not merely by transactions, but by structural joint ventures in maritime transshipment, renewable hydrogen, and advanced knowledge engineering. We stand ready to guide corporate leaders through both gateways."*

Affiliation: Director, European Regional Operations

Secretariat: The Ceylon Chamber of Commerce

VICE PRESIDENT (SRI LANKA)

Asoka Wickremasinghe

Managing Director, Maritime & Freight Corridors (Aitken Spence)

SECTOR: MARITIME LOGISTICS

VICE PRESIDENT (FRANCE)

Hervé Laurent

Regional Director, South Asia Energy Systems (Schneider Electric)

SECTOR: CLEAN ENERGY

HONORARY SECRETARY & SECRETARIAT

Niroshini Rathnayake

Senior Director of Bilateral Affairs, The Ceylon Chamber of Commerce

INSTITUTIONAL LIAISON

HONORARY TREASURER

Charles de Montmirail

Head of Trade Finance & Commercial Banking, South Asian Desks

SECTOR: TREASURY & AUDIT

CORPORATE CHAMBER ROSTER

Trusted by Leading Bilateral Enterprises

Representing leading sovereign institutions, conglomerates, and multinational operators driving commercial value.

Search member directory by industry, company name, or service category... SEARCH

CMA CGM MARITIME LOGISTICS	**TOTALENERGIES** ENERGY & INFRASTRUCTURE	**HAYLEYS PLC** CONGLOMERATE & EXPORTS	**DILMAH TEA** SPECIALTY AGRICULTURE
SCHNEIDER ENERGY MANAGEMENT	**JOHN KEELLS** LEISURE & LOGISTICS	**ACCOR HOTELS** HOSPITALITY GROUP	**MICHELIN** INDUSTRIAL RUBBER

Access Complete Verified Member Directory (180+ Enterprises) →

EXECUTIVE TESTIMONIALS

Institutional Endorsements

99

"The Council provided our engineering consortium with immediate, high-trust access to ministry decision-makers in Colombo. Their mediation was essential for establishing our regional offshore wind operations."

François Beaulieu
Vice President, French Clean Infrastructure Alliance

99

"Through the outbound trade delegations structured with Business France in Paris, we secured major distribution partnerships with high-end Parisian retailers for single-origin artisan Ceylon teas."

Malik J. Fernando
Managing Director, Resplendent Ceylon & Dilmah

99

"The Ceylon Chamber's institutional governance backstopping the SLFBC guarantees that every corporate dialogue adheres to rigorous bilateral protocol, statutory compliance, and commercial clarity."

Claire Dupont-Vasseur
Commercial Counselor, European Maritime Desk

BILATERAL COMMERCIAL CONDUIT

Let's Build Stronger Sri Lanka–France Business Connections

Whether you are a French enterprise expanding operations into the Indian Ocean or a Sri Lankan exporter entering the European Union, the Council is your accredited bilateral authority.

BECOME A MEMBER | CONTACT SECRETARIAT

THE CEYLON CHAMBER OF COMMERCE • EMBASSY OF FRANCE IN SRI LANKA & MALDIVES • MEDEF INTERNATIONAL PARTNER

SRI LANKA–FRANCE BUSINESS COUNCIL

The Sri Lanka–France Business Council (SLFBC) was inaugurated under the aegis of the Ceylon Chamber of Commerce to foster, promote, and expand bilateral trade, investment, joint ventures, and cultural exchange between Sri Lanka and the Republic of France.

ACCREDITED BILATERAL CHAMBER
Affiliated with The Ceylon Chamber of Commerce & The Embassy of France.

QUICK LINKS

- About SLFBC
- Bilateral Relations
- Leadership & ExCo
- Annual Reports & Audits
- Constitution & By-Laws

OPPORTUNITIES & SERVICES

- Trade Delegations & Missions
- Market Entry Sri Lanka
- Market Access France (EU)
- Bilateral B2B Matchmaking
- Customs & Tariffs Dossiers

SECRETARIATS

Colombo Secretariat:
The Ceylon Chamber of Commerce, 50 Navam Mawatha, Colombo 02, Sri Lanka
+94 11 558 8800 | info@srilankafrance.biz

Paris Liaison Office:
27 Rue de Berri, 75008 Paris, France
paris@srilankafrance.biz

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Privacy Policy | Terms of Membership | Diplomatic Protocol Disclaimer

2. About, Governance & Leadership

About the Council

The existing About page contains the Council's history and objectives. These are valuable institutional assets and should remain, but the copy should be broken into shorter sections with clear headings and visual anchors.

- **Who We Are**
- **Our History — Founded in 2004**
- **Our Role within the Ceylon Chamber of Commerce**
- **Our Objectives**
- **Sri Lanka–France Business Relationship**
- **Our Network & Institutional Connections**

Leadership / Committee Page

The committee page should clearly state the applicable year, for example 'Executive Committee 2025/26', and avoid mixing historical committee years with current information. The current indexed slfbc.lk version lists a 2025/26 committee, including a President, Senior Vice President, Vice Presidents, committee members and invited institutional representatives.

Recommended presentation: consistent professional headshots, name, role, organization and a short 1–2 line professional profile. Avoid displaying personal phone numbers or private contact information unless the Council has explicitly approved publication.

Ambassador Message

The Ambassador Message should be visually elevated as an institutional message page, with the Ambassador's name, title, date/year and a high-quality official portrait. The page should be reviewed annually so that the displayed Ambassador and message remain current.

4. Membership Experience

Membership is one of the strongest assets of the website. The current member page contains a substantial directory of companies, including international and Sri Lankan organizations across logistics, manufacturing, tourism, finance, ICT and other sectors.

However, the current presentation is essentially a long text list. This makes the directory difficult to scan and does not communicate the scale or diversity of the network visually.

Recommended Member Directory

- Search by company name.
- Filter by sector.
- Filter by Sri Lankan / French / international organization where applicable.
- Display company logo, company name and sector.
- Optional company profile page or external website link.
- Feature selected members on the homepage.
- Show a clear 'Become a Member' CTA.

Membership Application

The existing application page asks applicants to submit a business registration certificate, company profile, audited accounts for two years, applicable fees and two membership recommendations. The current page therefore contains useful operational information but should be redesigned into a clear application journey.

1. **Step 1 — Confirm eligibility**
2. **Step 2 — Prepare required documents**
3. **Step 3 — Complete application**
4. **Step 4 — Submit to the Secretariat**
5. **Step 5 — Committee review / membership confirmation**

The application fee/subscription figures should be reviewed and dated before publication because membership charges can change.

5. News, Events & Media

The current Events page contains a mixture of recent and older items, including Annual General Meetings, Ambassador meetings, networking sessions and events dating back to 2019. Several 'Read more' links point to slfbc.biz rather than keeping the visitor within the main website.

Recommended News & Events Architecture

- Upcoming Events
- Past Events
- News & Announcements
- Business Delegations
- Ambassador / Institutional Meetings
- Networking & Member Activities
- Media / Press Releases
- Photo Gallery

Event Card Standard

Every event should consistently show:

- Event title
- Date
- Location
- Short description
- Event image
- Registration or contact CTA
- Photo gallery / report after the event

Content Freshness

The homepage and event archive should not make the site appear dormant. If there are no upcoming events, replace an empty/old event block with a curated 'Latest Activities' or 'Upcoming Opportunities' section.

6. Country Information: France & Sri Lanka

The current navigation includes About France and About Sri Lanka. This is a useful differentiator for a bilateral business council, but these pages should be positioned as business intelligence resources rather than generic country descriptions.

About France — Recommended Content

- Business environment overview
- Key industries relevant to Sri Lankan companies
- Trade and investment relationship
- Major business regions/cities
- Market-entry considerations
- Useful French institutions and business organizations
- Trade fairs / business events
- Useful links and resources

About Sri Lanka — Recommended Content

- Economic and business overview
- Key export and investment sectors
- Infrastructure and logistics
- Tourism and services
- Investment ecosystem
- Market-entry considerations
- Relevant government/institutional links
- Business setup resources

Add a prominent 'Last Updated' date to both country pages. This makes the information more credible and helps prevent visitors from treating old content as current.

7. Contact & Conversion

Current Contact Issues

The requested website presents contact information in the footer, while other indexed SLFBC versions use different telephone numbers, email addresses and footer details. This creates a trust and maintenance issue.

Recommended Canonical Contact Block

Use one approved dataset across every page:

- Sri Lanka–France Business Council
- The Ceylon Chamber of Commerce
- 50, Nawam Mawatha, Colombo 02, Sri Lanka
- Telephone — verify current official number
- Email — verify current official Secretariat email
- Website — use one canonical SLFBC domain

Contact Form

- Name *
- Company
- Email *
- Phone
- Subject / Enquiry Type
- Message *
- Consent / privacy notice
- Submit Enquiry

After submission, show a clear confirmation:

Thank you. Your enquiry has been received. Our team will contact you shortly.

9. SEO & Content Structure

Recommended Page Titles

Page	Suggested SEO Title
Home	Sri Lanka–France Business Council | Ceylon Chamber of Commerce
About	About the Sri Lanka–France Business Council | SLFBC
Membership	SLFBC Membership | Sri Lanka–France Business Council
Members	Member Directory | Sri Lanka–France Business Council
Events	Events & Business Activities | SLFBC
News	News & Updates | Sri Lanka–France Business Council
France	Doing Business with France | SLFBC
Sri Lanka	Doing Business in Sri Lanka | SLFBC
Contact	Contact the Sri Lanka–France Business Council | SLFBC

SEO Content Improvements

- Add logo to the title of the page
- Add unique title tags and meta descriptions to every important page.
- Use one H1 per page and logical H2/H3 sections.
- Add descriptive image alt text.
- Keep publication dates and update dates visible on news and country-information pages.
- Use internal links between Members, Events, About, Membership and Contact.

Conclusion

SLFBC already has the most important raw ingredients for a strong institutional website: a defined bilateral mission, a long operating history, a substantial member network, committee leadership, event activity and a relationship with the Ceylon Chamber of Commerce. The main requirement is to turn these assets into a modern, current and easier-to-use digital platform.

The redesign should therefore focus on three outcomes: first, make the Council's bilateral business value immediately understandable; second, make the network and activities easy to explore; and third, make every important action—joining, attending, contacting, finding a member or learning about an opportunity—simple to complete.

Reference & Verification Sources

- Audit target: https://www.slfbc.lk/index.php
- SLFBC homepage and navigation: https://www.slfbc.lk/index.php
- SLFBC Members: https://www.slfbc.lk/members.php
- SLFBC Application: https://www.slfbc.lk/application.php
- SLFBC Events: https://www.slfbc.lk/events.php
- SLFBC Contact: https://www.slfbc.lk/contact.php
- SLFBC About: https://www.slfbc.lk/about_layout.php
- SLFBC Constitution: https://slfbc.lk/constitution.php

Audit note: This report is a website/content/UX audit based on the requested public site and publicly indexed supporting pages reviewed on 24 September 2026. Technical issues such as form submission, server errors, mobile breakpoints, analytics configuration and accessibility conformance should be confirmed with a live browser/device QA pass before development sign-off.